

Ostrich Eggs Party B

Day 1 · Session 1 · XYZ Chemical Company · Assigned role brief

Keep this brief private. Open only your assigned role.

You are the Chief Chemist for the XYZ Chemical Company, a international firm specializing in making pesticides to eliminate insects that are dangerous to agricultural crops. Recently, your representatives from around the world have reported a new outbreak of the Cottermus Moth. This moth can be extremely destructive to all kinds of trees and if left unchecked, can defoliate and kill whole forests within a matter of days. Once thought to be under control and nearing extinction, the Cottermus Moth has suddenly reappeared in large numbers on all forested continents. In two months, the larvae will hatch and massive forest destruction will result.

If the forests are defoliated, secondary impacts will be unprecedented soil erosion and the destabilization and loss of water resources. The moth could also move into agricultural lands and cause serious destruction to crops. Corn appears to be especially vulnerable to attacks by the moths. The only way to stop the moth is to spray infected forests with a special pesticide, Compound UO, which has not been manufactured for several years. Unlike most other pesticides which are synthetic compounds, the Compound UO is made from the eggshell of the rare spotted ostrich which is found in Africa. These birds are very few in number and lay their eggs only once each year. Their laying period is this month. The eggs for each year are usually stored and then sold to gourmet restaurants as thickeners for special soups. Last year's eggs have all been sold at an average price of \$15 per egg.

The only owner of these rare ostriches lives in a remote part of Africa. You do not think that he knows that there will be a new and increased demand for his eggs this year.

Ostrich Eggs Party B continued

As thousands of eggs will be needed to manufacture the pesticide, your company has determined that you will need all 10,000 of this year's production. Half of the insecticide will be needed in the western hemisphere; one-fifth will be needed for the United States. Your assignment is to get as many of the spotted ostrich eggs as possible (preferably, all the eggs). Your company has authorized you to spend up to \$500,000 to purchase the required eggs.

Along with the gourmet restaurants, there appears to be other competitors for the eggs. There is a rumor that the ABC Drug Company also wants them. (Your company has a pending law suit against them for patent violations.) You are concerned that the other company might try to outbid you.

You are flying to Africa to try and buy this year's crop of eggs. Now you have discovered that the person in the airplane seat next to you is the agent of the ABC Company. You are going to convince this person that your need for the eggs is so great you should get all of this year's crop. If you protect the interest of XYZ Company, you will surely be named the next President of the Company, a job that will pay you five times your present salary.